SOCIAL FINANCE

coram better chances for children since 1739

open data institute

Standards Development Working Group

Get Ready:
Go to www.menti.com
Enter code **1985 9957**

10th July 2025

PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

Things to be aware of

Conflicts of interest – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk.

Anti-competitive activities – Please inform the chair / secretariat if you think there is a risk of anti-competitive activity.

Intellectual Property - If you are concerned about the use of your contributions, please contact the secretariat.

Meeting Recording - We may record the meeting and using AI transcription tools.

Working together

1. Every voice matters
2. Please join in on the conversation, we don’t want this to be one way
3. If you’re happy to, keep your camera on
4. Please raise your hand if you want to come in, or drop your ideas in the chat
5. Respect the diverse viewpoints in the room, assume positive intent and remain open for different experiences

Agenda

1. Welcome to the working group.
2. Introductions and expectations.
3. Programme Overview.
4. Draft person specification introduction and review.
5. Ways of working and what next.

A unique opportunity to improve child safeguarding by improving data about children and their care.

SOCIAL FINANCE

coram better chances for children since 1739

open data institute

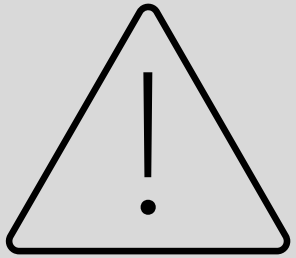
Department for Education

Introductions and expectations

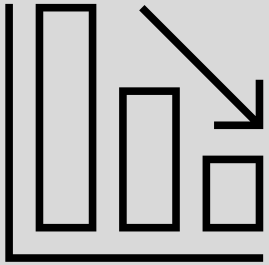
Go to www.menti.com
Enter code **1985 9957**

Programme Overview

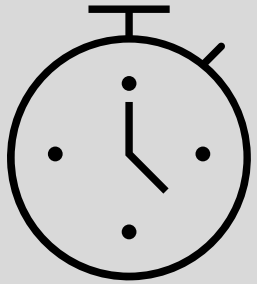
We're interested in using standards to drive four key benefits:



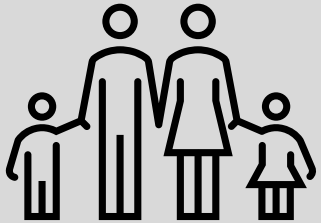
Improved data sharing to support safeguarding decisions



Better data analysis and strategic decision making



Improved productivity for social workers and a reduction in tech inhibiting processes

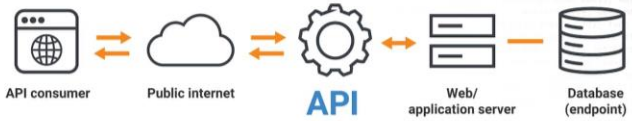


Increased power sharing with children and families

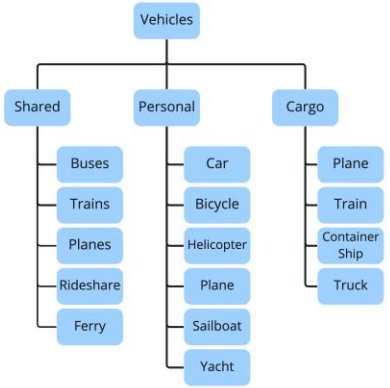
Data and interoperability standards allow for consistency in how data is collected, used and shared.

Standards in everyday life

Data and tech standards



Date 1(DD.MM.YYYY)	Date 2 (DD.MM.YYYY)
5-Feb-2019	05-02-19 0:00
05/02/2019 00:00:00	05/02/2019 00:00:00
5-Feb-2019	February 5, 2019
05/02/2019 00:00:00	February 5, 2019
05-06-19 0:00	June 5, 2019
05-06-19 0:00	05/06/2019 00:00:00
05/16/2019 00:00:00	05/16/2019 00:00:00
05/21/2019 00:00:00	05/21/2019 00:00:00

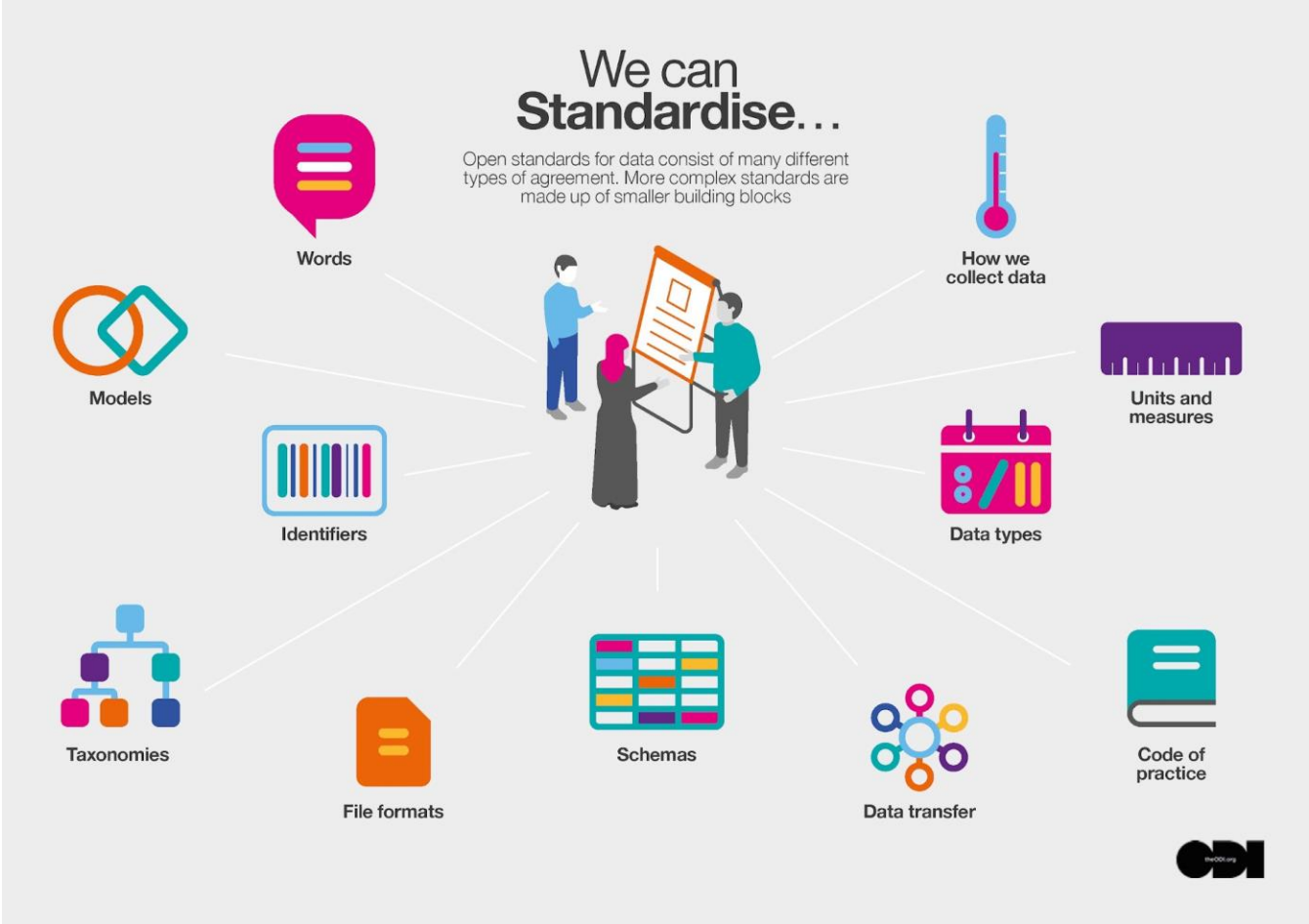


What are open standards for data?

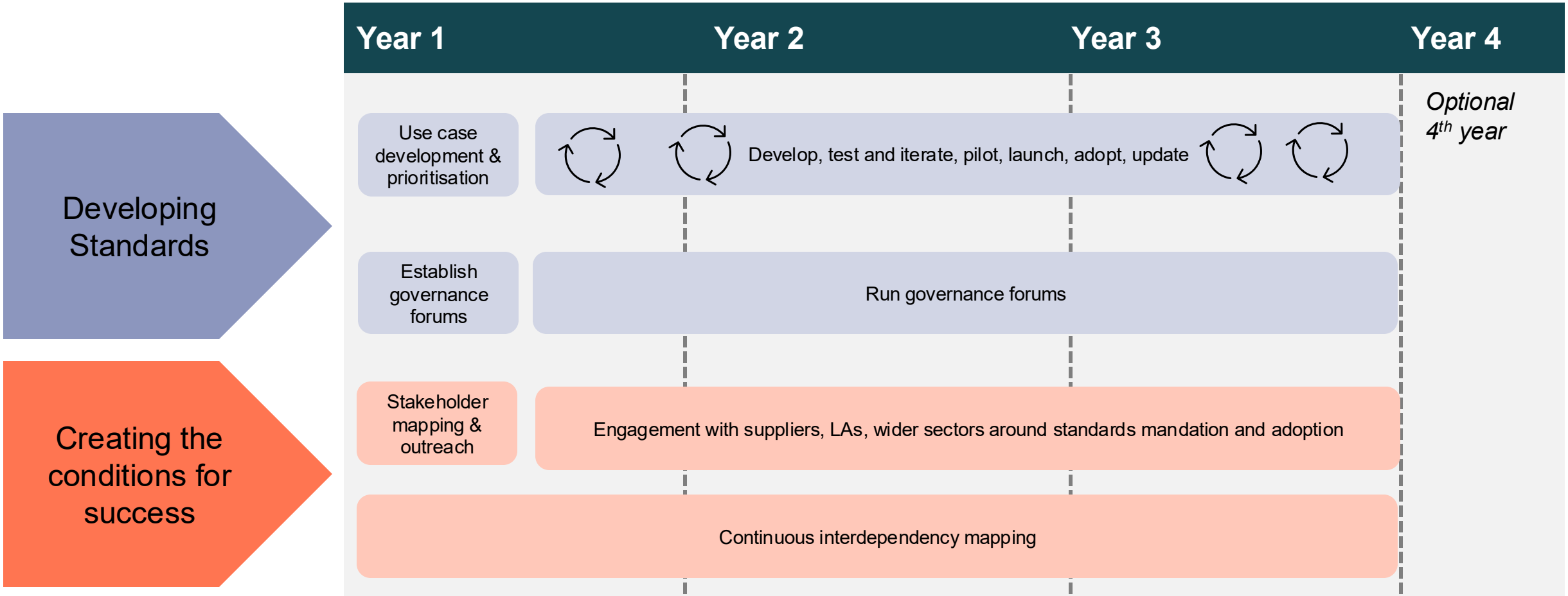
Standards are documented, reusable agreements that solve a specific set of problems or meet clearly defined needs.

An **open standard** is available for anyone to access, use and share, they are developed using open processes.

Open standards for data help us publish, access, share and use better quality data.



What might the next 3 years look like to help us solve the problems in the market using standards?



Where to Start?

During our first phase, running between January and April 2025, we identified 13 use cases under 6 categories:

Social Work recording and sensemaking

- Information capture
- Information retrieval

Children and families' experience

- Coproduction and input
- Access to records
- Carer experience

Care market management

- Care placement market analysis
- Brokerage and monitoring of care placements and providers

Business intelligence and analytics

- Data richness and reporting
- National data flows

Multi-agency information sharing

- A multi-agency view of the child
- Multi-agency input into a child's record
- Interagency data transfers

Procurement and implementation

- CMS procurement and implementation

We also identified lots of potential data standards

- Social care data standard
- Child data standard
- Core people data standard
- Core organisation standard
- Core information data standard
- Data quality standard
- Consent and data sharing standard
- Data exchange standard
- Data migration standard
- Permissions standard
- Data governance standard
- Data security standard
- Standardised reporting and analytics frameworks
- Social care messaging and notification standard
- Data entry, contribution & input standards
- Subject Access Request standard
- Commissioning data standard
- 3rd party integration standard

During our first phase, running between January and April 2025, we identified 13 use cases under 6 categories:

Multi-agency information sharing

A multi-agency view of the child

Distinct workstream

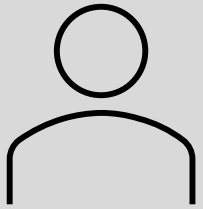
Placements

Care placement market analysis

Distinct workstream

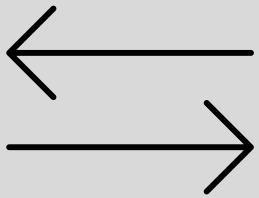
Standards for MAIS

Our Standards for MAIS



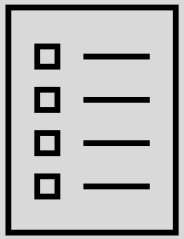
Person standard: Defining which fields should be standardised for a person

1st draft for review



Data exchange standard: To support movement of data between systems

In draft



CSC Taxonomy: To define key steps, interventions and individuals within CSC processes

Coming soon!

What the Person Standard will enable (and what it won't)

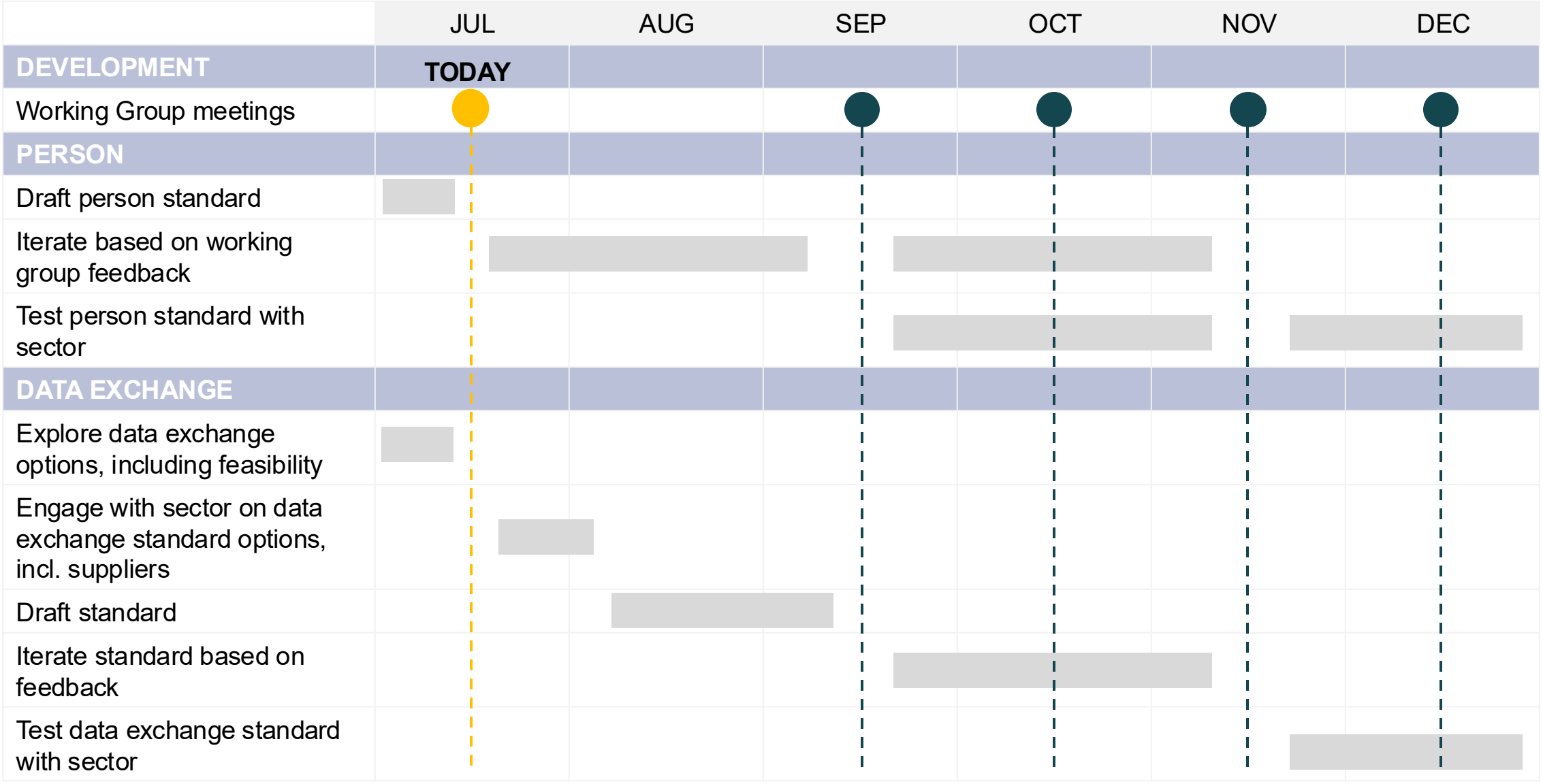
It will help LAs:

- Record consistent, quality data about people in the case system, particularly children.
- Identify if a record corresponds to an individual.
- Document the relationships between individuals.
- Associate data with individuals
- Aggregate data for use in analytics (with appropriate controls)

It won't …

- Prevent LA's recording data to meet local requirements (should minimise the need to do this)

MAIS Standard timeline



Standards for Placements

Why the Placement Standard matters

Care market costs are unsustainable and child outcomes poor

Market intelligence is key but hard without shared (data) 'language'

We can build on existing momentum in the sector to quickly have an impact

What the Placement Standard will enable (and what it won't)

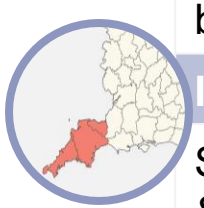
It will help LAs:

- Better understand placement sufficiency: what provision is needed, where, and at what notice
- Speak same language as neighbours to form regional view of sufficiency gaps
- Distinguish between different drivers of placement costs
- Make like-for-like comparisons of placement cost
- Forecast future demand for different placement types

It won't …

- Directly support home search or communication with providers
- Provide insight into placement outcomes (maybe in future versions)
- Establish a national standard referral form

Placement Standard timeline

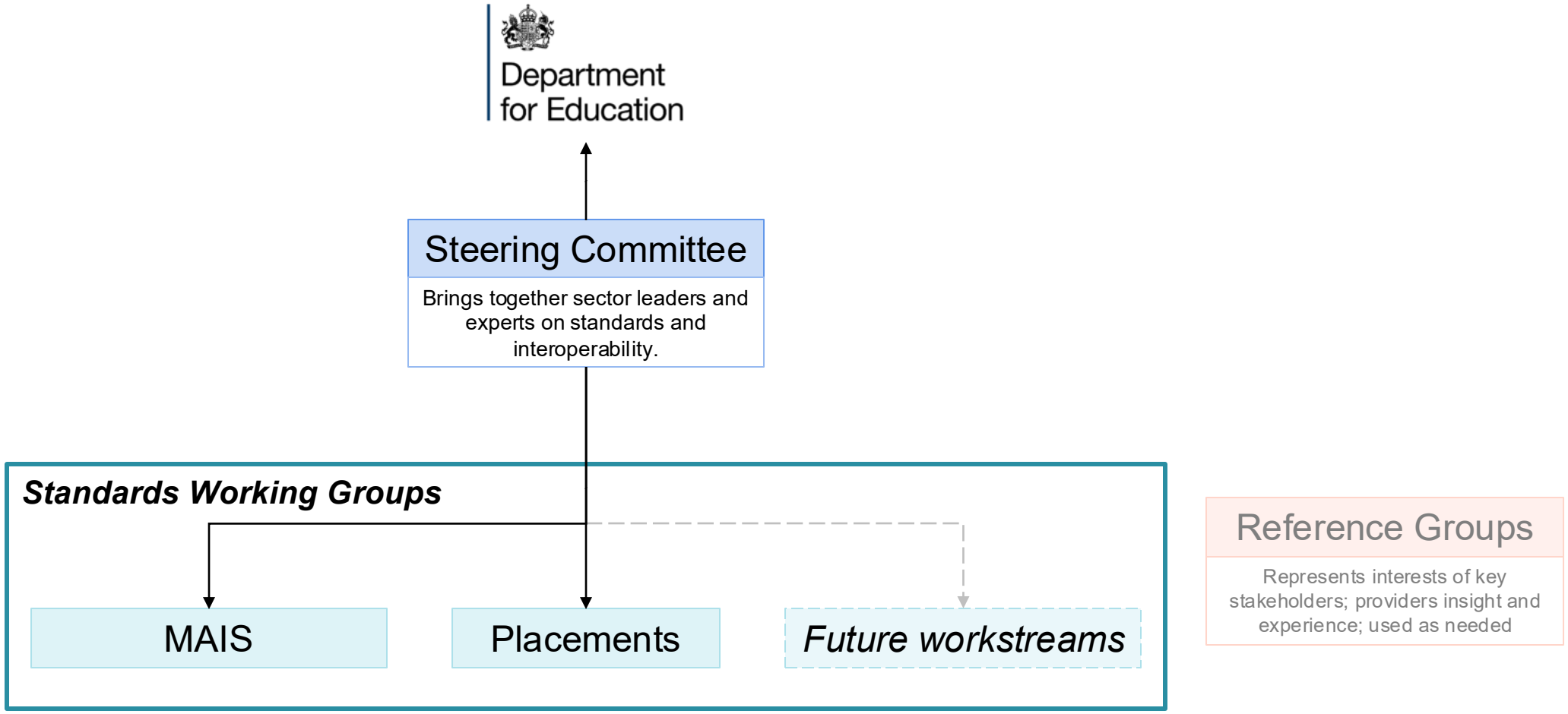


	JUL	AUG	SEP	OCT	NOV	DEC
DEVELOPMENT						
WG meets	●		●		●	
Refine standard based on WG input						
IMPLEMENTATION						
Set up governance & support materials						
Initial engagement with SW LAs						
Implementation trials						
Review and learning						

Q&A

How will the Standards Working Groups work?

Programme Governance



What is a Standards Working Group

Ensure standards are developed that:

- Meet the needs of all stakeholders.
- Directly address requirements identified.
- Are within the guardrails set by the steering group.

The Standards Working Group will:

- Own the enterprise data architecture and technical roadmaps required to enable open data standards to be implemented and adopted by stakeholders.

- Research, recommend or create data standards that respond to the use cases.

- Commission the technical infrastructure required to implement the standards.

- Collaborate to test the standards and infrastructure delivered by the standardisation initiative to ensure it is operable and performant.

- Promote the adoption of the standards, supporting organisations in developing business cases for change.

Meeting frequency and format

- We expect
  - The MAIS Working Group will need to meet monthly.
  - The Placements Working Group will meet bi-monthly.

- We are running as an open group attendees may change as the project moves forwards.

- Meetings will be primarily held online.

- **A shared workspace will enable standards working groups to collaborate between meetings.**

- Meetings will be recorded (for administrative purposes only), with a short meeting summary and slides published online.

GitHub Basics

GitHub is a powerful online workspace where teams can store, manage, and collaborate on projects, especially those involving computer code or other technical files.

We are using GitHub to:

- Store our specifications
- Track feedback on specifications (Issues)
- Host our initial project website
- Openly share project documentation
- Have Discussions to inform the development of standards

- In the future we will use GitHub to:
- Host and manage the development of any infrastructure or tools we need to develop
- Enable people to reuse our specifications and code

We will work to keep this simple and provide guidance when needed.

Website: https://socialcaredata.github.io/ (start here!)
GitHub: https://socialcaredata.github.io

Join at menti.com | Use vote code 1985 9957

Mentimeter

How can we help you participate in the working group?

All responses to your question will be shown here

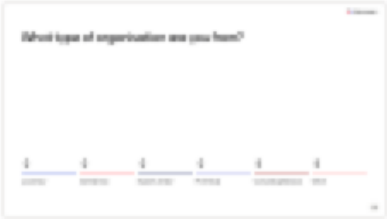
Each response can be up to 200 characters long

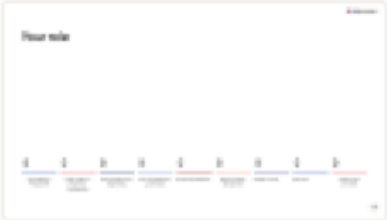
Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

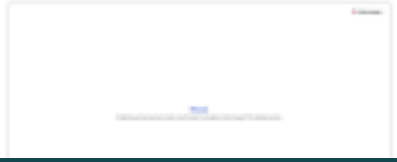
Menti

Standards Working ...

Choose a slide to present







Workshop Prep

Our Standards for MAIS

Person standard: Defining which fields should be standardised for a person

1st draft for review

Data exchange standard: To support movement of data between systems

In draft

CSC Taxonomy: To define key steps, interventions and individuals within CSC processes

Coming soon!

Review the Person Specification

During the break please familiarise yourself with the draft specification

Does this adequately describe a person in the social care system?

- What is missing?
- What needs to be added?
- How can it be improved?

If you want to…

- Review the issues other people have raised? Go to: https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/ and click issues
- Or create new issues (using the links in the spec).

After the break we will:

- Provide an overview of GitHub
- Work on some specific issues
- Talk about what happens next

Break

https://socialcaredata.github.io/spec/person/

MAIS Workshop

Person standard areas for discussion

Identifiers

- Initial feedback suggests we need to allow more than the single unique identifier.
- What is current practice around issuing and allocating identifiers to individuals?

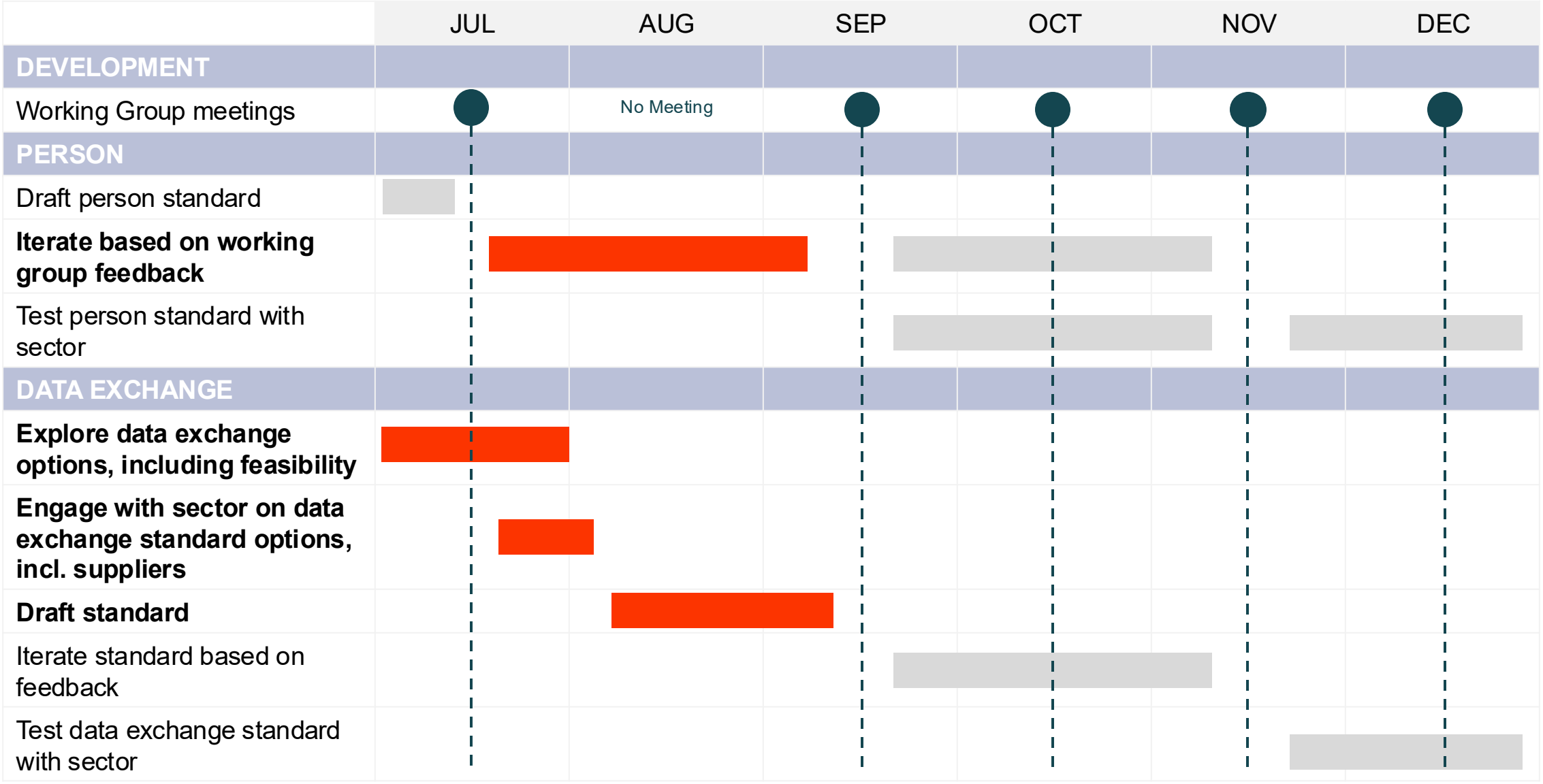
Addressing

- We have focused on the basics of an address: Property, Street, Town, Postcode, Identifiers.
- But what about the nuances of addresses: Types of address, confidence in address, unknown addresses, sensitivity of addresses.
- How can we improve our address model.

Descriptors of people

- We have focused on a specification to enable the identification of a person, but we know we need to also describe the person.
- What are the essential descriptors of people that we are missing?

Next Steps for MAIS



Lots of potential data standards

- Social care data standard
- Child data standard
- Core people data standard
- Core organisation standard
- Core information data standard
- Data quality standard
- Consent and data sharing standard
- Data exchange standard
- Data migration standard
- Permissions standard
- Data governance standard
- Data security standard
- Standardised reporting and analytics frameworks
- Social care messaging and notification standard
- Data entry, contribution & input standards
- Subject Access Request standard
- Commissioning data standard
- 3rd party integration standard

Join at menti.com | Use vote code **1985 9957**

Mentimeter

What do you think we should we be creating data standards for next?

All responses to your question will be shown here

Each response can be up to 200 characters long

Turn on voting to let participants vote for their favorites

Menti

Standards Working Gro...

What's your main goal for our time together today?

How can we help you participate in the working group?

Your reflections on today

SOCIAL FINANCE

coram better chances for children since 1739

open data institute

Thank you.

Contact:

Placements:
madeline.goldie@socialfinance.org.uk

MAIS:

Andrew.newman@theodi.org